

ROLEPLAYER CARD NO. 4

MEDICINE

SETTING Hospital Emergency Department

PATIENT

You are visiting Australia. You are quite upset because, about two hours ago, your five-year-old daughter was bitten on the face by a dog owned by the friends you are staying with. You washed the wound under cold running water and stopped the bleeding with a sterile dressing. If asked, you think your daughter had a tetanus vaccination last year.

TASK

- Answer the doctor's questions about the circumstances of the bite.
- Find out how the doctor is going to treat the wound.
- Be anxious about wound infection. Dogs eat filthy things.
- Be difficult (not impossible) to persuade that antibiotics are not needed.
- Find out how to care for the wound and how to recognise signs of infection.
- Be rather frustrated about the incident. You have no experience with dogs and your friends told you that their dog loved children.

CANDIDATE CARD NO. 4

MEDICINE

SETTING Hospital Emergency Department

DOCTOR

The patient is a five-year-old girl. She and her family are in Australia visiting friends. She has a small, superficial dog bite wound on the side of the face, near the hair line. You are speaking to her parent.

TASK

- Calm the parent. Find out the circumstances of the bite and first aid given.
- After examination, reassure the parent that the wound needs only cleaning and closure, and explain how you will do this.
- Antibiotics are not necessary – low risk of infection (e.g., a recent wound, the face has an excellent blood supply, etc.).
- Check on the child's tetanus immunisation status and explain whether a booster is needed (NOTE: Australia is free of rabies).
- Advise the parent on care of the wound – recommend a review after 48 hours.
- Advise on the need for constant supervision of children near dogs.